

TAB 24



Board of Education Report

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Ms. Gonez - “Éxito y Promesa: Deepening and Expanding Support for Multi Language Learners” (Res-027-23/24) (For Action May 7, 2024)

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District (~~District~~) is proud to serve students who speak 98 different languages at home;

Whereas, Approximately 85,000 English Learners (ELs), and 99,000 Reclassified Fluent English Proficient (RFEP) students make up approximately 44% of all students in the District;

Whereas, The Multi Language Learners (MLL) student population is heterogeneous including, among others, Potential Long-Term English Learners (PLTEL), Long-Term English Learners (LTEL), English Learner students with disabilities, English Learners identified as gifted and talented, as well as refugee and International Newcomer students, an MLL student population that has been rising steadily in recent years;

Whereas, The District is committed to supporting students who are Multi-Language Learners (~~MLL~~), including approximately 22,000 (5%) who are International Newcomers, as evidenced by ongoing efforts outlined in the LAUSD District’s Strategic Plan including targeted professional development, assigning trained staff to schools with a high concentration of International Newcomer students, providing instructional resources with EL-specific strategies to all teachers, assigning Multilingual Multicultural Academic Language Teams that support each region, and the creation of four International Network Academies and Dream Centers;

Whereas, The District is focused on decreasing the number of LTELs by providing targeted, supplemental supports in elementary and middle schools through the allocation of support staff who provide direct services to students and work with teachers to implement research-based strategies such as those highlighted in [https://www.lausd.org/cms/lib/CA01000043/Centricity/Domain/22/UTK-12%20Essential%20Instructional Approaches for Multilingual Learners](https://www.lausd.org/cms/lib/CA01000043/Centricity/Domain/22/UTK-12%20Essential%20Instructional%20Approaches%20for%20Multilingual%20Learners.pdf) [https://www.lausd.org/cms/lib/CA01000043/Centricity/Domain/22/UTK-12%20Essential%20Instructional Approaches for Multilingual Learners](https://www.lausd.org/cms/lib/CA01000043/Centricity/Domain/22/UTK-12%20Essential%20Instructional%20Approaches%20for%20Multilingual%20Learners.pdf);

Whereas, A measure of success for eliminating opportunity gaps is increasing EL reclassification rates to 25% (from 15.8% in 2019-20), and in the first year of the Strategic Plan, the District showed improvement in this area by increasing its EL reclassification rates to 21.8%;

Whereas, The 2023 Smarter Balanced Assessment (SBA) results show English Learners as the student group with the greatest Distance from Standard in English Language Arts, where the SBAs are comprehensive end-of-year assessments for English Language Arts/literacy and mathematics that measure progress toward college and career readiness;

Whereas, MLL high school students have class schedules that include state-required English Language Development (ELD) courses to achieve English proficiency which may delay access to a full range of courses, and the District is piloting a new grade-level ELD placement policy to expand ELs' access to grade-level coursework, including expediting International Newcomers' access to electives/grade-level English courses after their first year of ELD instruction;

Whereas, Newcomer students are a part of the overall MLL population but may also have unique needs, reflecting the traumas of the migration process, interrupted formal education, or other challenges, which necessitate specialized resources and programming;

Whereas, While wraparound services are available to newcomer students at the secondary level, the dispersal of newcomer elementary school students may pose resource gaps; and

Whereas, The Strategic Plan indicates that the District will pursue eliminating opportunity gaps by creating an inclusive environment, acting on early warning indicators to ensure students remain on track, and offering multiple opportunities for intervention and credit recovery during and after school, among other strategies; now, therefore, be it ~~therefore~~;

Resolved, That the ~~Board of Education~~ Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District reaffirms its commitment to ensuring that all MLL students have access to a rigorous, well-rounded, high-quality public education; ~~and~~;

Resolved further, That the Superintendent shall assess the holistic needs of MLL students and their families, the current provision of services, and explore additional strategies to deepen support, including:

- Increasing access to a diverse academic portfolio (including A-G coursework, electives and the arts), enrichment opportunities, extracurricular activities, technology, social-emotional resources;
- Updating protocols and processes for communications with families to ensure cultural and linguistic appropriateness, awareness and understanding, including on the reclassification process and college preparation (e.g. for undocumented students and their unique financial aid needs), and improving partnership with families so they can be equipped and empowered to support their children's learning at home;
- Updating protocols for language/interpretation services, especially in school communities where languages are spoken besides English and Spanish, such as Russian, Ukrainian, and indigenous languages from around the world;
- Building employee capacity to support all MLL students through culturally responsive practices and awareness of the social-emotional needs of newcomers, and creating career pathways including "grow your own" programs to ensure a pipeline of teachers who can meet the diverse needs of MLL and newcomer students;
- Creating partnerships with academic institutions and organizations specializing in multicultural education and the needs of International Newcomers; and
- Providing support to schools with high concentrations of MLL students and International Newcomers, such as providing additional staff, financial resources and wraparound services (e.g. legal and social-emotional support and resource hubs, such as Dream Resource Centers); and be it finally;

Resolved, That, with input from students, educators, and families, the Superintendent shall develop a plan for the 2025-2026 school year to fulfill the promise of our MLL students by addressing gaps in each of the areas listed above and report back to the Board in 120 days and as part of the annual Strategic Plan.